

Keys to Funding Success

1. Building Upon Your Community Strength – the Connection to the Ohio River

At one level, an advocacy agenda is a list of projects. And grant applications from localities are often just another set of papers in a large pile of submissions. The best advocacy agendas, however, stick together and support a broader vision for your community, and the best grant applications provide a compelling narrative about the focus and mission of a community. In your case, the connection of the communities to the Ohio Riverfront is a key organizing principle for ORBCo funding advocacy. The communities should seek to continue to “brand” themselves around their relationship to the Ohio River, weave the narrative of the River’s importance in your funding applications, connect with regional Ohio River organizations and causes, and use the restoration of the riverfront as a justification for funding agencies to provide resources. Moreover, the vision for redevelopment on the Ohio Riverfront created by the ORBC communities through the Area-Wide process should be used to move your plans and projects forward with key funding agencies and other supporters.

2. Building as a Region

Likewise, the ORBCo communities should distinguish themselves in funding applications by working together as a region, and tying into the broader Pittsburgh metropolitan area. Most or all funding officials will know and understand the Pittsburgh metropolitan region, and the ORBCo communities can identify themselves as small communities within this metro region seeking to promote better economic revitalization and quality of life for citizens of the region.

This means that the ORBCo communities must work diligently to build and maintain positive, ongoing relationships with key regional organizations, such as the Southwest Pennsylvania Commission, regional officers in federal and state agencies, and regional organizations such as the Ohio River Trail Council, Sustainable Pittsburgh and the Allegheny Conference on Community Development. In particular, ORBC communities need to get your projects listed in regional documents that are pre-cursors to federal and state funding allocations, such as the Transportation Improvement Plan, the Comprehensive Economic Development Strategy, and the Clean Water Intended Use Plan that is updated annually by regional organizations.

3. Organizing an Advocacy Team & Protocols for Regular Interaction

ORBCo communities can be most effective in pursuing funding priorities if you convene a team composed, with representatives from the four

communities and your key organizational stakeholders, consisting of folks like election officials, managers, key department heads, critical staff, your federal and state lobbyists, and any other important stakeholders. The team would prioritize which projects deserve the communities’ time and resources, and ensure that your communities are working toward those goals. This ORBCo team should meet together, and with key consultants, on a quarterly basis or more as necessary, to identify objectives, track progress, address obstacles, and assign next steps on your funding and project efforts.

4. Preparing an Annual Advocacy Agenda

Every year and sometimes more often depending upon circumstances and opportunities, face with local governments meet face-to-face with their advocacy consultants to prepare an advocacy agenda. This agenda serves two purposes. First, it identifies which projects will be priorities for the year, and clearly pinpoints the funding opportunities that might support those priorities. The priorities identified in the advocacy agenda should not be too voluminous, but rather focus on the most important projects in which the community wants to invest its time and resources to move forward. To arrive at this shorter list of community priorities, the advocacy team mentioned in #3 above should discuss and determine which projects are most crucial and are ripe for investment. Typically, an advocacy agenda will include 10 or fewer projects.

The second purpose of an advocacy agenda is to share with congressional, federal agency, and state leaders where their targeted support can be most useful. ORBCo communities should be asking its congressional and state elected leaders for support letters and phone calls to decision-makers on all of your priority projects. A focused advocacy agenda enables these leaders to understand where they can be helpful, and provides opportunities for supporters to identify additional funding for your community priorities.

Remember that an advocacy agenda shouldn’t be a static document. Things will change in both ORBCo communities and in Washington, DC.

ORBCo communities can develop a funding and advocacy agenda as a group, and can also establish their own community’s agenda for your particular project. These can be mutually supportive or, at least, identify funding areas where communities might have overlapping interests.

5. Matching Community Priorities to the Best Resource Opportunities

With clearly identified community projects and priorities, ORBCo communities should then match priorities against the best resource opportunities provided by the federal, state, philanthropic, and private sectors. This requires knowing the best funding sources, and the attached funding matrix provided as part of this Area-Wide plan is a good start,

Strategic Action Plan

Introduction

The four communities leading the Ohio River Brownfields Corridor effort, Midland Borough, Monaca Borough, the City of Aliquippa and Coraopolis Borough, have demonstrated success in obtaining federal, state and other funding for their community revitalization priorities. The establishment of the group’s Brownfields Area-Wide Plan should position the communities for even greater advantage in seeking grant funding and other resources.

Yet, because grants are becoming more competitive than ever, and funding programs can continue to be complex and difficult to navigate, the ORBCo communities should establish strategies and approaches for maximizing your competitive advantages and chances for success. This section provides recommendations on how the most effective approaches to seeking and obtaining resources for your community projects.

which can be supplemented through the S2 Spotlight email newsletter, regular communications with your consultants, and by signing up to particular agency/program listservs that send funding announcements. These potential resources should then be assessed to determine whether your projects will be eligible, and how your projects can be shaped and developed to be most competitive for funding. The best way to make this assessment is through direct interaction with federal agency program officers who administer these funds.

6. Developing Briefing Materials on Your Priorities

Once ORBCo communities has identified priorities for the advocacy agenda, we strongly recommend that your communities should develop concise briefing materials that explain the goals, planned activities and needs of each project. These materials, generally 2-page fact sheets, provide a clear summary of the proposed projects, and should be shared with federal and state officials, as well as other stakeholders. The fact sheets are important because they will provide funders and other supporters with more information about each of your priorities, and will be tailored to identify how particular agencies can support the community's goals.

7. Organizing Local Support

Granting agencies expect to see broad support for the projects that they will fund. Grant application windows are short, and you should be focused on developing a strong proposal during that time rather than just starting to educate the community-at-large about your priorities. After you complete your advocacy agenda and before the grant notices are even released, begin to build broad community support for your key projects. Be sure to touch all sectors of your community – business groups, homeowner associations, non-profits, environmental organizations, religious organizations, philanthropic foundations, educational institutions, regional groups, state agencies, and others. It would be prudent to create and maintain an ongoing contact database of key stakeholder contacts so that you can send e-mails or letters or organize phone calls quickly. For all organizations, ask them whether they would be willing to participate in the project, write letters of support for funding applications, or even provide matching funds toward projects.

You should also consider using traditional media as well as social media to get the word out on projects and keep the public involved. Send press releases at significant project milestones, post information on your website, create a Facebook page, and use other techniques to keep the strong backing of the community.

One particularly effective tool for project success is to form a task force to support a high-priority project. For instance, your community

could form a “Green Infrastructure on the Ohio River Task Force” or a “Complete Streets Revitalization Task Force” to support the development of particular projects. The purpose of these groups is not to make more work for community leaders, but instead to get organizations to agree to identify themselves with the project in a more official way, to convene them occasionally to report on progress and ask for further support, and – most of all – to be able to show funding officials the level and effective organization of buy-in at the community before grant solicitations are announced.

8. Using Plans to Get to the Next Key Stage

The four ORBCo communities certainly understand the importance of good community planning, given your active collaboration on the EPA Brownfields Area-Wide Plan. Keep in mind that federal and state funding agencies will want to see that plans, designs, engineering drawings, construction documents, permitting, and other pre-construction planning tasks are accomplished before they give you funding for project construction and implementation. That means that you should strive to move your project forward to the next stage of planning/engineering, whether through local resources or grant resources. Pay particular attention to federal, state, and philanthropic grants that support planning, design and engineering, because sometimes a relatively small grant for such planning can advance your project to a stage that it is ready to compete for bigger dollars.

9. Identifying Matching Opportunities Early

Many federal and state grants have matching requirements. Often, communities find that they cannot compete for funding opportunities because they do not meet the minimum match. And today, the minimum match is often not enough. To be most competitive, localities need to exceed matching requirements.

Your advocacy agenda should help you identify what matching requirements you'll need to produce for successful grants applications. Before the grant solicitations are announced, begin to identify how your community could meet and exceed the matching requirements. Local, state and regional organizations will be overrun with requests for funding when the grant notices are on the streets. Even your own governing council or board may be unable to act on matching needs within the 30- to 60-day time period of a grant application process, because such a matching request may not align with your own budgeting, capital planning and spending cycles. It is better to identify your overall advocacy priorities annually, identify the matches you may need, and plan and budget to meet them early, should the federal/state funding opportunities arise for those

projects. Build early support for your priorities, and identify potential sources of matching before the eleventh-hour.

10. Building Relationships with Federal Agency Leaders

ORBCo communities should develop relationships with federal agency officials to build support for your projects before grant solicitations hit the streets. With a clear advocacy agenda, you can know which federal offices to approach and cultivate. Relationships should be built with regional and Washington DC headquarters officials. These relationships and interactions can be nurtured through phone calls, e-mail correspondence, trips to the regional offices and Washington DC and, very importantly, invitations to these officials to visit your community and your projects. You want these officials to understand your goals and projects, and to think of your community when they are designing funding programs and grant solicitations. These agency leaders will be interested in receiving updates on your community's progress. Demonstrating that you are able to successfully move projects forward and fulfill your community's sustainability vision helps build confidence in your locality, making their future investment in your projects less risky. Obviously, your work on the Area-Wide Plan has given your communities a big boost in the effort to build federal agency relationships.

Also, it is very important to meet with the leaders of these departments before grant solicitations have been announced, as many federal agencies get skittish about meeting with local officials when funding opportunities are on the street, and most likely won't meet with your team if an application has already been submitted for consideration.

11. Identifying Alliances with Federal Elected Representatives

ORBCo communities should also focus on building ongoing, collaborative relationships with your congressional delegation, which includes Senator Casey, Senator Toomey, Congressman Mark Critz (pending redistricting), and Congressman Doyle. By conducting research on your representatives' interest, committee positions, legislation, and political activities, ORBCo communities will be able to connect your interests with theirs. The City should work with their district and headquarters staff to determine how your community projects and priorities advance their own interests, either on substantive issues or with respect to their efforts to build stronger support in your region of the state. For instance, Senator Casey is lead sponsor on a bill that would have the Department of Labor provide job training resources for workers working in the natural gas fracking industry, which could obviously be used to support working training programs related to the coming new cracker facility in your region.

ORBCo communities should be seeking the support of these federal representatives on all your projects, particularly the high-priority initiatives. Ask these leaders to write support letters that you can include in your grant package; however, support letters aren't enough. Engage these elected leaders and urge them to make phone calls with key decision-makers. Members and Governors will often contact Cabinet Secretaries directly for projects that they are invested in. These calls matter.

12. Building Relationships and Support from Key State Leaders

Likewise, build support from the Governor and state department leaders, at both the Harrisburg headquarters levels and in the regional offices. Schedule regular meetings with key state officials, and keep them apprised of your community's progress and needs. Besides positioning yourself for state funding opportunities, their backing at the federal level can often help you out-compete other Pennsylvania localities.

Also, for some federal grant opportunities, you'll need to be listed on your state's priority funding lists, such as the State Transportation Improvement Plan for transportation projects and the Clean Water/Drinking Water State Revolving Fund Intended Use Plan lists for sewer, stormwater and water projects. These lists may not be amended more than once annually. Make those requests early so that you are ready for those grant announcements.

13. Scheduling Regular Visits with Your Congressional Delegation in DC and Locally

It is important to establish relationships with the district directors and regional representatives of your congressional delegation. It is equally important that your faces be seen in the U.S. Capitol. There you can discuss your community priorities directly with the Member, as well as meet key staff members with expertise in those areas. That contact is critical, and demonstrates that your community is actively engaged in seeking federal resources.

We recommend a visit to Washington, DC at least once annually, with other visits as needed to lend further support to your community priorities. In addition, it is important to invite your congressional Members and staff to visit your community and see your projects at least once a year. It is particularly useful to include Members at important occasions, such as at the launch of key initiatives, gatherings of citizens and organizations, groundbreakings and ribbon-cuttings.

14. Building Capacity with Consultants

Every community, particularly smaller communities, has a limited capacity to conduct all of the activities that help you become more competitive for funding resources, including tracking funding opportunities, building advocacy strategies, putting together advocacy materials, conducting planning or technical analyses to support your funding efforts, organizing contacts and collaboration with congressional and agency officials, and drafting and submitting grant applications. Consider how to spend local resources to build and extend your local capacity, either as a group of communities or individually. Often these investments can reap multiple returns and benefits.

15. Celebrating Success

Grant success can lead to further funding success. However, no one will know that you were successful unless you celebrate your achievements. Host groundbreakings, ribbon-cuttings and other celebratory events, and invite your congressional delegation, state elected leaders and key federal agency officials to attend. Nothing succeeds like success, and nothing is more important to getting the next grant than to show that you can spend the first grant effectively.

Note also that this document identifies both funds that could support the four communities in a regional way, and funds that could be pursued for individual community projects. These Priority Projects are focused in six (6) key areas:

- Economic Revitalization; Transportation Infrastructure; Green Infrastructure for Clean Water; Shoreline Restoration; Parks/Recreation & Community Art; and Sustainability/ Smart Growth.

This matrix does not provide exhaustive information on the 50 potential sources of funding identified below. Instead, this matrix is meant to be the overall blueprint for ideas and opportunities for the communities of the Ohio River Brownfields Corridor.

RESOURCES ROSTER FOR THE OHIO RIVER BROWNFIELDS CORRIDOR

Funding Opportunities for Recommended Area-Wide Priority Projects

The following matrix, matches the top community projects of the Ohio River Brownfields Corridor communities involved in the Ohio River Area-Wide Brownfields Planning partnership, with the most promising opportunities for federal, state and private resources. The resources identified in this matrix have been included only if projects in these communities are expected to be eligible and competitive for such funding. The matrix also suggests key issues and next steps for pursuing and obtaining the identified resources.

This matrix should be considered as supporting information to the advocacy approach described above along with other documents and materials provided to the Ohio River Brownfields Corridor communities.

The matrix is organized into two areas:

1. Overall Approach to Effective Advocacy – identifying objectives and actions that the Ohio River Brownfields Corridor communities should pursue for a competitive edge in securing funding.
2. Ohio River Brownfields Corridor – Priority Projects that identifies priority projects, sources of funding and key next steps.

OVERALL APPROACH TO EFFECTIVE ADVOCACY – Success in obtaining funding takes a strategic, ongoing approach that can increase your competitive advantages. The key approaches and objectives below can help the Ohio River Brownfields Corridor communities increase your chances of obtaining funding for your priority projects.

Goal	Objectives	Strategic Approaches
Communities are Organized for Effective Action	• Clearly identified community priorities • Communities working cooperatively on a regional basis • Timely knowledge on funding opportunities • Ongoing collaboration among key community units and consultants for an effective local team approach • Strong public support for priorities • Strong grant writing and packaging abilities • Always prepared for match requirements	• Maintain ongoing, dynamic Strategic Advocacy Agenda, and use it to direct community resources (to create budgets for future grant matches, allocate staff resources for projects, etc.) • Affirm your Strategic Advocacy Agendas with official resolutions and implement them with top elected and staff leadership • Set up regional coordination team that includes both elected & staff; coordinate by email; meet quarterly and as necessary • Maintain tracking system for federal opportunities • Use briefing sheets for key projects • Utilize outreach, community meetings, social media, and other communications approaches to boost projects • Leverage funding sources & be prepared to match • Celebrate/publicize successes, hold events • Maintain an effective media strategy for priority projects • Establish grant writing team and drafting protocols
Communities have Built Key Relationships	• Strong alliances with key stakeholders, both within region and beyond • Fully engaged relationships with congressional delegation • Mutually supporting relationships with key federal agency officials and programs	• Maintain ongoing database of key stakeholder contacts • Regular briefings and communications (e.g., newsletters, e-mail reports) with key stakeholders • Form interagency & multi-stakeholder teams for key initiatives • Regular DC and regional office visits and other communications with PA congressional delegation • Regular interaction with targeted federal agencies • Engagement with state and foundation funding leaders • Build business, banking and finance backing

Economic Revitalization – Each of the four communities in the ORBCo, and the region as a whole, has a prime objective of fostering economic development, business attraction, and jobs creation. The following resources can be used to foster and support such economic revitalization.

Potential Resources	Key Issues & Next Actions	Potential Projects
U.S. EPA Brownfields Grants – Although the Allegheny County Redevelopment Authority has received Brownfields Grants in the past, none of the ORBCo communities have yet taken advantage of these important resources. However, ORBCo has a strong foundation for applying for EPA Brownfields support because of the strong planning conducted through the Area-Wide Partnership, and should consider: • Targeted Brownfields Assessment Grants: EPA Region 3 will provide a locality, at no charge, brownfields assessment and characterization at a targeted site, through a relatively simply letter application. • Assessment Grants: These grants provide up to \$200,000 to localities, regional councils, development authorities for site assessments, reuse planning and community outreach and collaboration to address hazardous waste and/or petroleum contamination. • Consolidated Assessment Grants: EPA will provide up to \$1 million in assessment funding for coalitions of communities – which may be a great fit for the ORBCo communities. • Cleanup Grants: These \$200,000 grants to localities and other parties can be used to clean up hazardous waste and/or petroleum contamination on sites owned by the grantee. • Cleanup Revolving Loan Fund Grants: These grants of up to \$1 million can capitalize a fund that can be used for low/no-interest loans to private sector parties, or grants to local government entities and non-profits, for cleanup of hazardous waste and petroleum contamination. Supplemental RLF grants: can be obtained through a relatively simple application if you have expended a substantial amount of your original RLF grant.	• ORBCo communities should target specific sites for assessment and cleanup based on an evaluation of which sites meet grant eligibility criteria, which sites are most prepared for progress, and which sites can leverage resources. • ORBCo communities should convene with EPA Region 3’s Brownfields & Land Revitalization Office to discuss opportunities for grant funding. • Work with the New Jersey Institute of Technology’s “Technical Assistance for Brownfields” (TAB) program to get support in drafting grant applications. • ORBCo communities should consider visiting Washington, DC to meet with key EPA Brownfield officials including Assistant Administrator Mathy Stanislaus and EPA Brownfields Director David Lloyd.	• All the brownfield areas of the four communities could use TBA or assessment funding to identify contamination issues, assuming landowner is cooperative • Sites owned by the locality (or state) can potentially use cleanup grant, RLF grant, Multi-Purpose, or PA Reuse funds

Economic Revitalization		
Potential Resources	Key Issues & Next Actions	Potential Projects
The EPA assessment, cleanup, and RLF grants will likely be opened up in September 2012, with a likely 60 day application period. Other grants that may be announced later this year or early next year include: • Environmental Workforce Development & Job Training Grants: Provides up to \$200,000 for programs to recruit and train people in environmental fields including brownfields assessment and cleanup, green infrastructure, clean energy & other fields • Brownfield Multi-Purpose Grants: New pilot program to provide up to \$400,000 that combines brownfields assessment and cleanup grants to support flexibility at the local level. Also consider: • Targeted Assistance to Brownfields: Need help applying for brownfields grants or other support? The New Jersey Institute of Technology has been designated a “TAB Center” by EPA to support mid-Atlantic brownfields efforts. • PA DEP Industrial Site Reuse Program: This State program provides brownfields assessment grants and loans of up to \$200,000 and cleanup grants and loans of up to \$1 million at former industrial sites.		
Economic Development Administration (EDA) – EDA can provide a variety of resources to localities that meet economic distress criteria (per capita income at <80% of national levels; unemployment more than 1 point higher than national level; and/or special impact from a major plant shutdown or other economic crisis). Projects must be listed in the	• The key first step is to coordinate with the Southwestern Pennsylvania Commission and the Allegheny and Beaver County representatives to that entity, see www.spcregion.org. • Determine whether your area meets the EDA’s	• Key is to apply for EDA funds when jobs will be created or retained because of the infrastructure investment

Economic Revitalization		
Potential Resources	Key Issues & Next Actions	Potential Projects
“Comprehensive Economic Development Strategy” (CEDS) of the Southwestern Pennsylvania Commission. Applications are due quarterly each year. Resources include: • Local Technical Assistance Grants: can be used to address local economic challenges through market analyses, feasibility studies, and highest-and-best use analyses • Public Works & Economic Development Grants: Provides grants of up to ~\$1-3 million to construct or rehabilitate public infrastructure and facilities that are essential to job creation and economic development. Grants can be provided to support business incubators, industrial parks, and utility infrastructure needed for a private development, among other uses. A 50% non-federal cost share is generally required. • Economic Adjustment Assistance Grants: Essentially identical to the Public Works Grants, but reserved for areas suffering from major plant closures or natural disasters.	economic distress criteria: Aliquippa appears to meet under the Per Capita Income factor; Coraopolis appears to meet under both the PCI and unemployment factors; Midland appears to meet under the PCI factor; and Monaca appears to meet under the unemployment factor; these should be verified with the EDA Philadelphia regional office. • Projects are most competitive when the infrastructure/development investment will lead to job creation or retention. • Projects must be in the Commission’s CEDS plan. That CEDS already includes the Monaca Riverfront Park and the “Ohio River Industrial Site Improvements” at former the LTV property in Aliquippa, Monaca and other localities. • EDA funding decisions are made primarily at the Regional Office level which, in the ORBCo’s case, is the Philadelphia Regional Office. Work with EDA Economic Development Representative Andrew Reid, see www.eda.gov/contacts.htm.	• Planning grant could be used for highest-and-best use studies at targeted sites, or for job spin-off opportunities from major regional economic assets • Potential projects: Aliquippa’s Franklin Avenue improvements; Coraopolis 3rd Avenue Extension; Midland Steel Way; Monaca’s 17th Street Gateway Corridor or Colona Steel development area
HUD Block Grant Resources – HUD has a set of programs, all grouped under the Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) program, that can support a wide variety of activities including economic planning, property acquisition, infrastructure upgrades, community centers, brownfields revitalization, clean energy projects, low- and moderate-income housing, and other purposes. All four ORBCo communities are HUD CDBG “Non-Entitlement Communities,” which means that you do not get a direct allocation of funding from HUD, but must obtain your funding from Allegheny County (for Coraopolis) and Beaver County (for Aliquippa, Midland and Monaca). Beyond CDBG funding from the Counties, the communities could seek to leverage more funding, in the form of “Section 108” loans, which are low-interest, 20-year federally	• CDBG resources are typically distributed by Counties by a fairly rote formula, and thus the ORBCo communities need a strong, meritorious project to secure higher levels of CDBG grants or Section 108 loans. A major community project identified by the Area-Wide Plan could be considered for these HUD funds. • The HUD Neighborhood Revitalization Initiative grants are not widely advertised, which means that communities must be pro-active with their HUD Field Office (in Pittsburgh) and Congressional delegation to pursue high-priority projects that need such HUD support.	• These HUD funds could be used on CSO infrastructure projects needed in all communities • As Section 108 funds must be repaid, and must be used for business development • HUD Neighborhood Revitalization could be used for riverfront development planning and projects

Economic Revitalization		
Potential Resources	Key Issues & Next Actions	Potential Projects
guaranteed loans for any eligible CDBG purpose. These loans must be collateralized by the County’s CDBG program. In addition, there is a little-known, \$10 million, White House/HUD “Neighborhood Revitalization Program” that provides grants of up to \$250,000 to support economic development in local communities.		
Appalachian Regional Commission – ARC can provide grants for a range of industrial site development, business incubators, business development, education and training programs, and road and other infrastructure upgrades in communities. Match rates are 70% in Allegheny County and 50% in Beaver County. Additional resources may be available if your particular community is designated “distressed” by ARC.	Seek the support and guidance of the local ARC contact for your communities at both the Southwestern Pennsylvania Commission, and from the State ARC contact, Neil Fowler in the PA Department of Community and Economic Development	Consider Riverfront development projects or road upgrades
USDA Rural Development Resources – USDA resources are generally available only to communities of less than 25,000, with a particular emphasis on communities of less than 10,000, which means all four communities are likely able to access these funds, including: Community Facilities Grants & Loans: for community facilities, emergency responder facilities, hospital and health facilities, and other community improvements. Business & Industry Guaranteed Loans: Administered through State-level USDA offices, providing guarantees for 80% of loans for businesses to acquire property or buildings, modernize or expand facilities, or purchase equipment and supplies. Rural Business Opportunity Grants: USDA provides nearly 50 of these grants each year, of up to \$50,000, for community economic development, technology-based economic development, feasibility studies and business plans, leadership and entrepreneur training, rural business	USDA outreach and funding is conducted primarily by Local Rural Development and the Pennsylvania USDA Rural Development offices. Contact the Butler Area Office of USDA Rural Development at www.rurdev.usda.gov/PA_Contact_Us.html#Butler.	- Coraopolis Train Station - Community green infrastructure projects for stormwater - Midland west-end parking lot - Community infrastructure on riverfront - Business recruitment, feasibility, and incubator projects

Economic Revitalization		
Potential Resources	Key Issues & Next Actions	Potential Projects
incubators, and long-term business strategic planning in struggling communities. • Rural Business Enterprise Grants: Relatively small grants to public entities for projects such as business incubators, public infrastructure, revolving loan fund assistance, land acquisition and development, and construction, conversion, or renovation of buildings, plants, machinery, equipment, access streets and roads, parking areas, and utilities.		
SBA Section 7(a) Business Loans – is SBA’s primary program to help startup and existing small businesses obtain financing when they might not be eligible for business loans through normal lending channels. It also is the SBA’s most flexible business loan program, since financing can be guaranteed for a variety of general business purposes. Businesses that are located in rural areas, have been impacted by the North American Free Trade Agreement (NAFTA), and are exporters can access financing through this program.	• ORBCo communities can help businesses seeking to locate or expand in your communities to access SBA loan resource and technical assistance. Refer them to the Pittsburgh District SBA Office, or www.sba.gov/category/navigation-structure/loans-grants/small-business-loans/sba-loan-programs/7a-loan-program	• For small businesses seeking to locate or expand in your communities
PA Department of Community & Economic Development (DCED) Resources – DCED provides a variety of economic development funds to support infrastructure upgrades and business investment. DCED uses a “Community Action Team” (CAT) approach to support priority projects, and assigns a “Strategic Investment Officer” as a single point of contact. Key sources of funding include: • Infrastructure Development Program: grants up to \$1.25 million for public infrastructure including transportation projects, brownfields site improvements, water / sewer / stormwater, energy facilities, parking facilities, waterways, telecommunication infrastructure, and land and building rehabilitation at former industrial sites. • Housing & Community Development Assistance: provides grants of \$150,000-\$200,000 for community	• Contact the Southwest PA Community Action Team representative Jack Machek at DCED in Pittsburgh to discuss promising economic development opportunities and obtain guidance on applying. • Applications are submitted through a “Single Application for Assistance” process. • For Governor’s Revitalization Assistance Capital Grant, need to be in state Budget Itemization Act, and clearly must work directly with state representatives’ and Governor’s offices.	• These programs could potentially support a number of the projects in each community • Consider Elm Street program for Midland Steel Way, Monaca 17th Street Corridor and River Boulevard, Aliquippa Franklin Avenue improvements, or Coraopolis 3rd Avenue and Neville Avenue extensions

Economic Revitalization		
Potential Resources	Key Issues & Next Actions	Potential Projects
revitalization and economic development projects, as well as housing rehab. • Keystone Communities Enterprise Zone: deteriorated industrial areas with a five-year business strategy can get priority consideration for DCED grants and incentives, and businesses located in a Zone can get business tax incentives, priority consideration for state contracts, priority consideration for state brownfield resources, up to \$350,000 in Enterprise Zone RLF loans, and various grant opportunities. • New Communities Programs including Main Street & Elm Street Programs: The Main Street Program provides “Anchor Building” grants and “Downtown Investment” grants of up to \$500,000, and the Elm Street program provides up to \$250,000 to support a staffer over a 5-year period for planning and physical improvements to residential and mixed-use areas in proximity to central business districts. See www.newpa.com/sites/default/files/uploads/NewCommunitiesProgramguidelines08.pdf for detailed descriptions and requirements. Another potential State funding source: • Redevelopment Assistance Capital Grant Program: \$125 million annual program that provides grants administered through the Governor’s office for the acquisition and construction of regional economic, cultural, civic and historic improvement projects. Two funding rounds per year, with next likely coming ~ 4 months before April 2013. Must be a project included in a PA Capital Budget Itemization Act. The program has set criteria and funding preferences, projects must have a business plan, must have a 50% match, and the minimum funding request must be \$1 million.		

Economic Revitalization		
Potential Resources	Key Issues & Next Actions	Potential Projects
Federal Home Loan Bank of Pittsburgh – Provides, through its member institutions of local banks and finance organizations, low cost loans and credit support to local governments and others for its “Community Lending Program,” which can support development of public facilities and infrastructure. Also provides intensive training, support and partnerships with philanthropic foundations through the “Blueprint Communities” program. See www.fhlb-pgh.com/housing-and-community/index.html	• If a development projects needs funding, approach a Member of the FHLB of Pittsburgh, see www.fhlb-pgh.com/about-us/our-customers.html, and consider visiting the FHLB’s Director of Community Investment Programs.	
PENNVEST Brownfield Redevelopment Loans – The State will give loans of up to \$11 million to a single municipality or \$20 million to a joint application of 2-3 municipalities for 2.5% interest loans from the State’s Clean Water State Revolving Fund. See www.portal.state.pa.us/portal/server.pt/community/available_funding/11211/brownfield_redevelopment/560728 for terms and conditions.	• The process starts with a consultation meeting with a PENNVEST representative together with a PA DEP representative, which then leads to an application through PENNVEST. Contact Larry Gasparato at www.portal.state.pa.us/portal/server.pt/community/financial_assistance/9321/get_regional_assistance/541647.	• Monaca acquisition of McClymond’s site and/or expansion of development at Colonna Steel

Transportation Infrastructure – A central recognition of the ORBCo Area-Wide Plan is the need for road and trail upgrades in each of the four communities, and among them through the Ohio River Trail. Federal transportation funding is currently conducted through a 24-month piece of legislation called MAP-21 that puts forth a significant pool of funding for community projects, but also puts most authority for funding decisions with the State DOTs – even more than in past years. To be proactive, the ORBCo communities must work closely with PENNDOT and the Southwest Pennsylvania Commission.

Potential Resources	Key Issues & Next Actions	Potential Projects
Federal Earmark Reallocation: The U.S. Department of Transportation recently de-obligated and took back \$436 million in funds that had been congressionally earmarked in the years FY2003-FY2006, on projects that have died, stalled, or not made reasonable progress. This includes \$28 million in projects in Pennsylvania. U.S. DOT will allow each state to spend this money, and reallocate it to projects that are ready to go. PENNDOT has until October 1, 2012 to submit a list of projects for use of the \$28 million fund, and has until December 1, 2012 to obligate such funding.	• If any of the ORBC communities has a ready-to-go project (designed, engineered, permitted), it should send a letter ASAP to the Pennsylvania Department of Transportation requesting funding from the \$28M earmark fund, and should work with your state representatives to press for a grant.	• Any of the transportation projects that are ready-to-go.
Surface Transportation Project (“STP”) Funding – U.S. DOT estimates that Pennsylvania will receive \$340,000,000 per year for both of the two years of MAP-21. This can be used on construction and improvements to roads (defined as federal-aid highways, although a state <u>may</u> spent up to 15% of its funding on “rural minor collectors”), bridges, bicycle and pedestrian trails, alternative fuel vehicle infrastructure, and other purposes. The law requires that States apportion half its funding each year among different sized communities, so there will be funding set aside for smaller localities like the ORBCo communities. In addition, the State <u>may</u> (but not <u>must</u>) spent this	• The key to obtaining State transportation funding is to have your projects listed in the “Transportation Improvement Plan” established by the Southwest Pennsylvania Commission, and the corresponding “State Transportation Improvement Plan” established by PENNDOT. In general, the more outreach and collaboration to SPC and PENNDOT, the better. Consider enlisting State reps and senators for help. • Determine which of your projects can be classified as “federal-aid highways” or eligible “rural minor collectors”, which makes them potential eligible for STP funding. Route 51, Franklin Avenue, Kennedy Boulevard, Mill Street, Monaco Road, and Kane Road in Aliquippa seem to qualify; Route 51 & Maple Street in Coraopolis seem to qualify; Route 168 in	• Aliquippa Franklin Avenue improvements; Coraopolis 3rd Avenue and Neville Avenue improvements; Midland Steel Way; Monaca 17th Street and Monaca River Boulevard projects • Could be used on Ohio River Trail

Transportation Infrastructure		
Potential Resources	Key Issues & Next Actions	Potential Projects
STP funding on recreational trails, pedestrian facilities and other non-road purposes.	Midland seems to qualify; and Route 18 and Route 51/65 in Monaca seems to qualify. The ORBCo communities should work with your state municipal organizations and State representatives to push PENNDOT to allocate 15% of funding to small communities, and spend on transportation enhancement-type projects, as is permitted by the federal law.	
PENNDOT “Transportation Alternatives” Funding – The MAP-21 legislation mandates that each State <u>must</u> use 1% of its funding allocation and <u>may</u> use up to 2% of its funding allocation on these “Transportation Alternatives” projects which include non-motorized trails, sidewalks, transit stations, and other walkability/sustainability projects. In PA, that means \$16-\$32 million a year, for two years, for these projects. This “Alternatives” fund replaces the Transportation Enhancements, Recreational Trails, and Safe Routes to Schools programs that have been traditionally funded by U.S. DOT through the states.	- Again, get your projects into SPC’s TIP and the PENNDOT STIP - Again, work with your allies to push the State to use the full 2% allocation of funding for these Alternatives projects	- Ohio River Trail - Aliquippa Franklin Avenue Trail; Coraopolis Train Station restoration; complete street elements of Midland Steel Way; complete street elements of Monaca road improvements - Potentially could be used for green infrastructure on road facilities.
U.S. Department of Transportation (DOT) TIGER V Grant Program – DOT provides approximately 40 annual TIGER grants for projects that foster complete streets, sustainability and livability, economic redevelopment and safety. Average grant is \$12 million, and you must provide a non-federal match of 20+% to be competitive. State support is very important. Must be a very well-conceived project that has substantial progress already on planning, design/engineering, environmental evaluation, and funding leverage.	Composing a compelling TIGER grant for the ORBCo communities is achievable but difficult. No individual road/trail project in any of the four communities likely rises to the level of competitiveness necessary to win a TIGER, and a mish-mash of different roads put into, for instance, one “Ohio River Regional Roadways” project needs to demonstrate that the projects are related and cohesive. We doubt that the Ohio River Trail project, in itself, would be a clear TIGER competitor. However, as an EPA Area-Wide Planning pilot, you will have an advantage in the competition. The ORBCo communities should follow up with regional and HQ U.S. Department of Transportation officials to discuss the feasibility and approach for a successful TIGER application.	Combination of Ohio River Trail and riverfront access roads, combined into a compelling “Ohio River Regional Roadways” project.

Transportation Infrastructure		
Potential Resources	Key Issues & Next Actions	Potential Projects
Congestion Mitigation & Air Quality (CMAQ) – Pennsylvania will have approximately \$106 million each year in 2013 and 2014 to provide grants for transportation projects that reduce vehicle emissions in localities that are non-attainment for Clean Air Act standards – which both Allegheny and Beaver Counties are.	• Again, will need to work with Southwest Pennsylvania Commission and PENNDOT to build support for projects that could obtain CMAQ funding. • Will likely need to do technical work to show that traffic/VMT reduction, walking/biking projects will reduce vehicle emissions.	• Ohio River Trail

Green Infrastructure for Clean Water – All of the Area-Wide communities are on the Ohio River, each seeks a better connection to their waterfront, and each is struggling with water quality issues including stormwater management and Combined Sewer Overflow issues. This section focuses on resources to support CSO, wastewater and stormwater management issues, including the use of “green infrastructure” approaches to addressing those issues.

Potential Resources	Key Issues & Next Actions	Potential Projects
Clean Water SRF Fund – the longtime traditional source of funding for wastewater infrastructure and, in the past decade or so, for stormwater infrastructure has been the ‘Clean Water State Revolving Fund’ or “SRF” program. The SRF is funded and guided by the U.S. Environmental Protection Agency, but administered by PENNVEST. These resources are <u>loans</u> with generally favorable terms, and the funding process is more appropriate for larger, more expensive projects than smaller projects. For FY12, Pennsylvania has \$56 million from U.S. EPA for these projects, which is probably an indication of the size of the fund in future years. In addition to the traditional Clean Water SRF program for wastewater projects, PAVEST also provides approximately \$5.6 million annually for nonpoint source / stormwater and other “green reserve” projects. PAVEST also will provide approximately \$5 million annually in loan principal forgiveness and longer loan terms to “disadvantaged communities” (based on a state analysis of how much a loan would raise customer rates above a benchmark level).	To obtain either an SRF loan or a Green Reserve loan, contact the lead for PENNVEST in their Region 2 Office (Larry Gasparato, at www.portal.state.pa.us/portal/server.pt/community/financial_assistance/9321/get_regional_assistance/541647 and the PA DEP contact in the Southwest Regional Office (Dale Mills in Pittsburgh at 724.442.4000).	- CSO projects for big SRF loans - Green infrastructure projects on site redevelopments, particularly along the River
Corps of Engineers Section 313 Environmental Improvement – A special authority was created in Congress in 1992 to provide funding to 15 counties in southwest Pennsylvania, including Allegheny and Beaver, to provide design and construction assistance for “Environmental Infrastructure” including wastewater treatment, water treatment and supply, and green infrastructure.	Corps funding for Environmental Infrastructure can be difficult to secure, as it is typically not included in the President’s budget, and has foes in the Congress. The ORBCo communities will need to work closely with both your congressional members Mark Critz and Mike Doyle, and with the Pittsburgh and Baltimore Districts of the U.S. Army Corps of Engineers, who share responsibility for the management of these Section 313 funds. You will want to get a project agreement for environmental infrastructure from these Corps offices, and have your project included for funding in the districts’ “work plans” submitted to Corps HQ in the fall of each year.	Could potentially be used for a green infrastructure project to address CSO problems among the four communities along the Ohio River corridor.

Green Infrastructure for Clean Water		
Potential Resources	Key Issues & Next Actions	Potential Projects
EPA Green Infrastructure Program (“GIP”) grants – EPA provides technical assistance packages of between \$30,000 and \$75,000 in value that can be used to design community green infrastructure programs and projects. There is likely to be a solicitation for applications in the first half of 2013. See http://water.epa.gov/infrastructure/greeninfrastructure/gi_support.cfm.	- The ORBCo communities should decide whether and how their individual stormwater challenges can be addressed through collaboration on key next steps for design, funding and implementation of solutions. Such a plan for collaboration can be a basis for approaching funding agencies, like EPA, that can provide grants for taking next steps. - Coordinate with EPA Region 3 officials working in green infrastructure in both the Water and Brownfields offices, and coordinate with the Green Infrastructure Program leads in EPA HQ’s Office of Water.	Could be used for any of the four communities’ green infrastructure planning, or collectively as a group
Clean Water Act Section 319 grants – Approximately \$3 million a year in these grants are provided by PA DEP to local governments and nonprofit groups for watershed assessments, watershed restoration projects, and projects of statewide importance. The grant requires a 60% local match and 25% of the construction costs of practices implemented on private land must come from non-federal sources.	Contact Pennsylvania DEP’s Jeff Fliss in the Southwest Regional, Lower Ohio River Basin office at 412-442-4207 to determine whether ORBCo green infrastructure projects could obtain priority consideration.	Green infrastructure and stormwater management projects.
EPA Urban Waters grants – EPA annually provides a number of these grants to local governments, working cooperatively with community and/or environmental groups, to support planning and community outreach on the protection of key waterways. Grants average \$50,000.	- Like in the GIP description above, the communities should determine whether and how cooperation on green infrastructure and water improvement programs can help you move your designs and strategies to the next step. - It would be very helpful for the ORBCo communities to reach out to Pittsburgh-area environmental groups working on water quality and green infrastructure issues, as they have great clout with EPA on funding issues, and could help you secure and use some of these grants. Certainly continue to work with the Ohio River Trail Council and its allies. Other potential partners: Pennsylvania Environmental Council; Trout Unlimited; the Three Rivers Wet Weather Demonstration (www.3riverswetweather.org/), or Sustainable Pittsburgh, which has Beaver County and Allegheny folks on its Board of Directors (and see its Sustainable Community Development Network) at www.SustainablePittsburgh.org.	Could be used on individual community projects or in a continuing green infrastructure collaborative.

Shoreline Restoration – Each community seeks to better utilize its Ohio River shoreline for community activities, economic development, tourism, and environmental stewardship. The U.S. Army Corps of Engineers has a long history of activity on the Ohio River, and could potentially provide resources for shoreline restoration and improvements that support and enhance the communities’ waterfront redevelopment.

Potential Resources	Key Issues & Next Actions	Potential Projects
U.S. Army Corps of Engineers Continuing Authorities Program – The Corps has several “Continuing Authorities Programs” (CAP) that support feasibility studies, design and engineering projects, and construction for projects. Key authorities for Ohio River shoreline improvements could include: • Section 313 – special authority created for Southwest Pennsylvania, described above. • Section 22 Planning Assistance – to conduct feasibility and planning studies for potential Corp projects on waterways. Maximum grants of \$500,000 annually in any one state, with a 50% match. • Section 1135 Planning Assistance – planning, design, engineering and construction funding for improvement of areas that have been degraded by past Corps activities. Maximum federal share is \$5 million, with 25% non-federal match required. • Section 206 Aquatic Ecosystem Restoration – for environmental improvements to waterways. Could be used for shoreline restoration, vegetation, creek improvements. Maximum federal share is \$5 million with 35% non-federal match required. • Section 14 Emergency Shoreline and Streambank Restoration – if shoreline restoration is needed to protect against loss of public infrastructure or facilities, maximum federal expenditure \$1.5M, no match required. However, this program has been gutted of funding in recent years. • A project under a Corps authority may use up to 10% of the project funding to support recreation along waterways, which could support a trail or riverfront park construction activity.	• Key is to work cooperatively with the USACE Pittsburgh District Office, and then build support at the Great Lakes & Ohio River Division and HQ levels (particularly for larger-cost construction components). Contact USACE Pittsburgh District’s Deputy District Engineer for Project Management, Lenna Hawkins at (412) 395-7105 • A key first step will be to get agreement from the Pittsburgh District to include an initial feasibility study in District’s Budget Work Plan for 2013 or 2014. Feasibility studies can lead into planning, design, engineering and then construction projects. Note – the Corps is strained and can be cumbersome to work with.	• Aliquippa Riverfront festival grounds, Logstown outfall • Green infrastructure for stormwater in any of the four communities.

Parks & Recreation – Funding for parks and recreation, although critical for communities, has taken severe cuts during the economic downtown. The ORBCo communities must have strong, well-conceived projects, and work closely with funding agencies, to be able to compete.

Potential Resources	Key Issues & Next Actions	Potential Projects
PA Community Recreation and Conservation Program – The Pennsylvania Department of Conservation and Natural Resources (DCNR) provides grant funds for public parks, recreation, and trails projects. This is funded by a combination of state resources and the federal Land and Water Conservation Fund program. One key source, the “Keystone Recreation, Park and Conservation Fund” was funded again this year by the state legislature. Planning grants are typically <\$50,000, and construction grants are typically between \$150,000 and \$200,000. Match requirement is 50%, except for communities with a population <5,000 and a project of <\$60,000, which can receive a lower match requirement to as low as 0% match.	• Contact Kathy Frankel in the DCNR Southwest Regional Office at (412) 880-0468 or KFrankel@pa.gov	• Ohio River Trail, and any of the communities’ riverfront park projects.
DCNR Rivers Conversation Program grants – Rivers Conservation grants are awarded to municipalities, counties, municipal authorities, educational institutions and non-profit organizations to develop watershed/river-corridor conservation plans; acquire land or develop projects to address the recommendations in those plans. Grants can only be given for sites/locations listed on the PA Rivers Conservation Registry and recommended in a completed Rivers Conservation Plan; it is not clear that there is a plan that covers the ORBCo’s stretch of the Ohio River.	• Contact Kathy Frankel in the DCNR Southwest Regional Office at (412) 880-0468 or KFrankel@pa.gov, with the first task to determine whether ORBC communities can qualify under the River Conservation Program.	• Waterfront green infrastructure projects

Sustainability / Smart Growth – The Monaca-Aliquippa/Coraopolis-Midland area-wide plan is essentially a plan for smarter, more sustainable growth. The communities can seek additional resources that support sustainability and smart growth.		
Potential Resources	Key Issues & Next Actions	Potential Projects
Wells Fargo / National Fish & Wildlife Foundation “Environmental Solutions for Communities” grants – will provide grants of up to \$250,000 to localities for, among other focus areas, community-based conservation projects that protect and restore local habitats and natural areas, enhance water quality, promote urban forestry, educate and train community leaders on sustainable practices, promote related job creation and training, and engage diverse partners and volunteers; and demonstration projects that showcase innovative, cost-effective and environmentally-friendly approaches to improve environmental conditions within urban communities by "greening" traditional infrastructure and public projects such as storm water management and flood control, public park enhancements, and renovations to public facilities. Must have a 1:1 match with the Wells Fargo grants. Expected to be released soon, and due December 2012.	• Call and coordinate with the director of the Wells Fargo program, Ashley Grosh at the Wells Fargo Foundation, Environmental section.	• Green infrastructure for stormwater along river • Aliquippa riverfront festival grounds; Coraopolis train station revitalization; Monaca and Midland riverfront revitalization
U.S. EPA “Smart Growth Implementation Assistance” (SGIA) and “Smart Growth Building Blocks” assistance – Under these programs, EPA provides a team of experts on sustainable growth and community renewal to review issues and suggest approaches for addressing those issues. The SGIA assistance is more robust and intensive than the Building Blocks assistance, but more competitive. These are programs that can give a community nice profile and better relationships with key national smart growth leaders. EPA assistance competition expected to be announced September 2012.	• The ORBCo communities should identify how EPA smart growth assistance can be a follow-on to the successful collaboration of the Area-Wide grant, and then contact both EPA Region 3 and HQ staff in the smart growth offices to discuss potential projects.	• Perhaps a project to identify zoning and other incentives for riverfront redevelopment, together with approaches for green infrastructure

Sustainability / Smart Growth		
Potential Resources	Key Issues & Next Actions	Potential Projects
HUD Sustainable Community grants – The Obama Administration funded two programs through HUD, a “Sustainable Regional Planning” grant that supports planning for community revitalization, affordable housing and sustainable infrastructure over larger-scale, metropolitan regions; and a “Sustainable Community Challenge Grant” program that provides grants to individual localities for urban renewal planning and implementation projects. Both were de-funded in FY2012, and it remains to be seen whether the \$50 million pending for these programs in the FY2013 budget will be passed by Congress. If they are funded, the ORBCo communities should be very well positioned, to compete for this funding, particularly given your AWP success.	• The ORBCo communities should consider advocating for the funding of the HUD Sustainable Community grants to the Pennsylvania congressional delegation. • ORBCo communities should brief the HUD Pittsburgh Field Office on the results of the AWP, and discuss potential ways to build on the plan with future HUD grants.	• A HUD Sustainable Community Challenge grant would be an excellent tool for more detailed planning and engineering of community revitalization projects in ORBCo communities.
The Funders’ Network for Smart Growth & Livable Communities, Local Sustainability Grants – The Funders’ Network for Smart Growth & Livable Communities will provide up to \$75,000 to local government grantees that match that amount from a local or regional foundation, to support a variety of local sustainability initiatives including the establishment of financing programs for green buildings, funding local sustainability offices, fostering large scale behavioral change (e.g., better practices to reduce stormwater impact), promoting local food systems, and waste reduction programs. See examples from the first funding round at www.fundersnetwork.org/participate/green-	• Two key steps: determining whether you have a competitive project and compelling need; and finding a local or regional community foundation to provide the match. Could seek out the support of the Three Rivers Community Foundation, the Beaver County Foundation, the Pittsburgh Foundation, Check this list to see if you have good relationships with any of these community foundations: www.foundationdatabook.com/Pages/or/orlinks.html.	• Perhaps a project to promote deployment of green infrastructure by businesses and residents

Sustainability / Smart Growth		
Potential Resources	Key Issues & Next Actions	Potential Projects
building/local-sustainability-matching-fund/lsmf-ay-2012-awards . Next round is due October 2012, but there will be future rounds in 2013.		
Urban and Community Forestry Grants – This funding is used to encourage the planting of trees in Pennsylvania communities. Municipal challenge grants provide 50 percent of the cost of the purchase and delivery of trees. In Pennsylvania, grants for tree planting of up to \$15,000 per municipality can be given under the “TreeVitalize” program. See www.treevitalize.net/SubGrant.aspx The Pennsylvania Community Forest Council also provides “Municipal Challenge” grants to cover the cost of planting up to 50 trees, “Municipal Tree Restoration Program” grants in partnership with utilities to help ensure tree planting that does not interfere with overhead wires, and “Tree Improvement Grants” to support better care of existing trees. See www.pacommunityforests.com/grants/index.htm.	• Contact the PA DCNR “Service Forester” for your county, at www.dcnr.state.pa.us/forestry/yourwoods/serviceforesters/index.htm. • Contact the Pennsylvania Community Forestry Council in Harrisburg at www.pacommunityforests.com/contactinformation/index.htm	